

Angelo Pignataro 50³/₄

Account of my travels
back home from
the Philippines.

Written in Diary
form to Mom &
Dad.

50171

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1.

Jan 4, 1946

We received orders today to return to the states & to report at San Francisco. It came as a surprise because we didn't get into dry dock yet. I can't explain how happy we all were. We needed fuel & water so we went to Leyte to get them. On the way the engine craped out & we were all pretty sore. In a few minutes the scuttlebutt was going around that it would take 12 days to fix it.

2.

There goes our chance
of going home. Because
as soon as the base
command knew of it
they tell us to stay
here. But our captain
didn't radio in &
they went to work
to fix it. Its now
10 P.M. & I guess I'll
turn in.

Jan 5 1946

I awoke this morning
& the first thing I
heard was that the
engines were fixed.
That sounded pretty
good. We got under
way for Kyele again.

3.

We arrived alright &
got filled up in a
few hours. Well
done to leave tomorrow
cause of some details.
There weren't any movies
tonight & the night
was lonely & slow.
But I'll take it now
that we're going
stateside, I need to turn
in.

Jan 6, 1946

Today we got
started for home
at 1300. I went to
work as usual.
At 1330 we finally
got started. Everyone

was up getting their
 last load at the
 Philippines. (I hope)
 were going pretty
 slow because of our
 bad engine. But as
 long as we started
 we didn't care. We got
 out of the harbor
 into the open sea in
 a short while we
 couldn't see any land.
 This noon most of
 the men were talking
 of getting sea sick,
 & they did. They
 were wearing for
 hours. I can say
 truthfully I felt

funny, but I didn't
 get sick. I guess
 I'm an old salt
 with sea legs. No
 more mail for about
 28 days I hear. I
 didn't tell anyone
 of my homecoming
 because I want to
 surprise them. But I
 think I'll write at
 Pearl Harbor & let
 them know. I don't
 want them to worry
 because I'm not
 writing. The trip will
 take about 41 days
 because of our engines.
 We made only two

6.

stops. That's at
Eniwetok & Pearl Harbor.
Then D.F.usco & the
ship is to be decom-
missioned & we might
get a 30 day leave.
The captain told us
that. I can't wait,
I'm so excited & glad
I'll tomorrow - Good
night.

Jan 7, 1946.

The sea is still
very rough & the
men are still sick.
The ships rocking
very bad. That's
because our holds
are not full of

2.

cargo. Water is coming on the decks. The life lines were put up in case a wave hits you, then you can hold on. Our water has been rationed & its pretty tough. Its only on for 3 hours a day in one hour periods. We have to use salt water for showers & to wash our clothes. The laundry isnt working because of the water shortage. The water isnt exactly low but it has

8

As he used this way
if we want it to last
till pearl 7 fathoms.
Which is still about
26 days away. Will
be at sea a long time.

Jan 8 1946

Sea still rough
when I awake. A
couple of guys fell
out of their sacks.
Went to work & here
I am. Voyage is
pretty slow & long.
We can't make good
speed because it
might hurt the
engines. Still no
waves. I hear will

9.

have them only on
Saturday nights now
because we only have
3 aboard ship. Water
returning getting worse.
Salt water isn't good
for laundry, I found
that out. I mess mail
now.

Jan 9, 1946

Water calm now
& the ship isn't
rolling much. Today
we'll be using target
practice & use the
ammunition up. I
fired the 30 caliber
rifle, 20 millimeters,
30 caliber machine guns,

3 inch gun & the 4
 inch gun. The 3 & 4
 make quite a bit of
 noise. The 4 inch
 has some flash too.
 Everyone got a chance
 at each gun. We
 had some ammo
 left over so they
 threw it over the
 side. The gunnery
 officer said we
 used more than
 \$21,000 worth of ammo
 & threw away about
 \$6,000 worth. We had
 orders not to bring
 any ammo back
 so we used it up.

11.

I sure was some
waste. But its no
good anymore. My
right arm is sore
from that rifle.
Tell tomorrow. See
you soon.

Jan. 10, 1946

Well here it is Thurs.
night & time to write
days accounts. Woke
up this morning & the
sea was pretty rough
again. Its rolling like
a pea in a tub. If
my ship was full
of supplies I would
feel much better. Today
we had a few drills.

They were, fire drill
 abandon ship drill, &
 collision drill. Everyone
 has to wear a life
 jacket now because
 its so rough. They
 were issued ~~to~~ us
 the first day at sea.
 After work I went up
 for some more sun.
 I got some tan now
 and I'll lose it as
 soon as I hit Princeton.
 This will show you
 how slow we're going.
 So far we've only
 gone 553 miles. We
 still have 6,663 miles
 to our first stop

13.

at Brunetake. We've
been having a head
wind all the way
& also a strong current.
That's had much traveling
for being at sea for
4 days. At this rate
we'll never hit the
states. We got movies
tonight. I know I'll
enjoy it because I
sure love to see
movies. I'll let you
know the name in
tomorrow's story. We
only see movies every
week now on Thurs.
Good night all & hope
to see you soon.

14.

Jan 11, 1946

Up here this morning at 6:30 & the sea was pretty calm. I hope it stays that way. Still making very slow progress. Rumor is going around that we have to stop at Guam. I hope it doesn't delay our trip. I'm very anxious to get to the states. Last night movie was "What a Woman" with B. Aherne & Ross Russell. Enjoyed it a lot. So long till Sat mte.

Jan 12, 1946

Well here it is Sat. night & still out at sea.

15.

The seas been the roughest today than it ever was. The Captain told us we're going to Guam. for sure now. It will delay us about 4 days. At least we might get liberty there. We need food supplies. We ran out of Spuds 3 days ago & vegetables 2 days ago. Food is very low. It might be rationed. The men are also flooding No. 1 & 5 holds to balance the ship. Its been rolling very bad. Lately. The screw comes out of the

16.

water on every roll.

It's been running the engine. We might also get a tug at Guam cause we're going to slow.

Jan 13, 1946 At Sea
Well, we've been at Sea one week now & it seems like one year. Water still very rough but ship isn't rolling so much now that the 1 & 5 holds are full of water. It's safer now. Will arrive in Guam on Wed. We will get liberty there. Water & food still rationed.

17.

Its getting tougher
now. Having money tonight
because were going to Guam
& we can get more of them
good wghl.

Jan 14, 1946 at Sea
Well another day has
passed & Im getting
closer to home. Thats
all we talk about
now. Today was pay day
because were getting
liberty in Guam & we
need money. I didnt
draw all my money.
Im saving it for when
I come home. Then I
can have a good time.
We started a anchor

pool today. We get 60 men
to put up a dollar each.
Then we got 60 sealed
envelopes with numbers
in them from one to 60.
Everyman puts his name
on one of them. When
we hit Guam & the anchor
drops its recorded to the
minute on the bridge.
So if its 4:35 the man
with the number 35 wins
\$60.00. We'll starting one
for frisco soon for
\$5.00 per man. That's a
300.00 prize. We will
arrive in Guam tomorrow
I think. Then will find
out who has won.

19.

I finished a good book last night. The name was "Valiant Libertine" by John Bryson. It took me quite a while to finish it because I only can read it at night. It's the longest book I ever read. It had 627 pages. I enjoy reading now. At one time I dreaded it. Well till tomorrow mite.

Jan 15, 1946 At Port-Guam
We arrived at Guam today after being at sea for 9 days. It was good to see land again. Guam is same place. It's the biggest Naval Base in

20.

the Pacific. There are over
a 100 ships in the harbor.
We were anchored near
the aircraft carriers
"Hornet" & "Barker". Besides
a few C.V.C.'s will be here
till Sunday then will begin
our trip home again. We
took the water and of us,
105 holds & will putting
150 aircraft engines
in them. We're also getting
supplies. Water isn't rationed
in port so now we have
fresh water showers.
Till tomorrow night!

Jan. 16, 1946 - at Port - Guam

I waited your letter
this morning & I know

21.

you'll be happy when
you hear him coming
home. I had a hard
day today. Everyone had
to work to clean out
the 5 holds so we can
put cargo in. I put in
8 hours in the galley
or then 5 hours in the
holds. When we were
fueling up today I met
a buddy from West Camp
on the Oil Tanker. His
name is Bill Horner. He's
stationed in Guam. He lives
in Jersey. We moved to a pier
today. At 8.00 P.M. I met
a fellow who was on here
in Lytle. He was transferred.

22.

He's stationed here also. He has a jeep & I was driving it all night. It's now 11:30 so I was driving for about 3 hours. Those jeeps sure can go. He's coming tomorrow again. I hope we shone off Sunday.
Good night. x

Jan 17 - At Port - Guam
Well, it's now Thursday night & I just came back from the movies. I had a full day today also. I worked from 8 to 12 in the holds & then went on liberty & then I worked in the galley from 3 to 7.30 P.M. I sure know

23.

a guy out. It sure is
still ashore on
Guam. Swimming cokes
& beer, all you want.
I swam all afternoon.
Just like you see in
the movies. A nice white
beach; only ~~no~~ girls! =
Still loading up. That's
all for now.

Jan 18 1946 - at Sea Guam
Still loading up &
working like mad. I
didn't work so hard
since I came on here. I
had off tonight so I went
ashore. I went to a movie
on the Base. I seen Gordon
my pal, with "F. Mackinnon".

That's the first picture
I seen that I enjoyed.
No breaks, no rain, no noise
& no separate reels. It
was shown at "Hobbit
Bowl" outdoor theatre.

I also seen a U.S.O.
show with 5 beautiful
American girls. They
sure looked swell.
Runway will be in tomorrow
instead of Sunday. So
hang.

Sat: Jan 19 - At Sea -
We left Guam this
morning at 0700. We
sure were glad to get
started again. Sea
is getting rougher

25.

tonight. Cargo god helping
much. Still rolling.

Sun. Jan 20, 1946 - At Sea

Today makes 2 weeks
at sea. We still got 6
weeks left till we hit
Puerto. Engines still bad.
Trip very slow. Last night
we found out that the
ship is going to the
East Coast after Puerto.
I was happy cause its
closer to home but it
takes too long through
the Panama Canal. Good
old "Bklyn Navy Yard". Keep
praying. xx

Mon. Jan 21 - At Sea

Today we found out that

our cargo is. megos, carbines,
 .45's, shoes, gaschutes &
 aviation coats. We're all
 trying to get one of each. I
 heard that song "Long
 Hong Time" 3 times & I like
 it better every time.

Jan 22, 1946 At Sea

Had a fire drill & abandon
 ship drill this morning.
 Sea isn't very rough
 now. Going very slow.
 Picture tonight was
 "Billie To Post" - "Ide Ruper".
 I can't wait to come home.
 I hope we go a little
 faster. Good night x
 - Jan 23. At Sea - Wed.
 Last night I got my

27.

self a - aviation jacket,
combat shoes & work
shoes (2 pair). No carbene
yet. I wonder if I can
get all this stuff off.
Expect to hit Ennetoko
Saturday. Then P. H., Trues,
& H. G. O'Bag!

Thurs. Jan. 24, 1946 - At Sea

Nothing new today! We're
going a little faster now.
I'm sure is a long trip.
I've been at sea for 19 days
now & I still have 3
times that much to do yet.
Tough move was "Chip off
the old block" W. O'Conner &
"Ryan" Good night &
hope to see you soon.

28.

Jan 25, 1946 At Sea - Fri.
Sea getting rough
again. Nothing new!
Reaching Eniwetok
Sunday morning. I hope
we get mail. That's all.

Jan 26, 1946 At Sea -
Today we found
out that we were not
going to the East Coast
Islands. I'm glad. It
would have taken too
long to go through the
Canal.

Sun. Jan. 27. 1946 At Port
Here some more
news. We were told today
that we're going to be
decommissioned in 7 months.

29.

on April 15th And
everyone has a good
chance of getting dis-
charged! I'll keep this
a secret for now from
your letters. Refused
promotion today to
S.C. 3/c. I always wanted
to be a petty officer.

Arrived at Bundelapur this
morning. Received 36 letters.

Mon. Jan. 28 1946 - At Port-

Went on liberty today.
I even had a Coke. Expect
to leave tomorrow. Wrote
some more letters home.

Tue. Jan 29, 1946 At Sea.

We got more fuel & water
this morning & shaved off.

30

Water rationed again.

-Wed-Jan 30, 1946 - At Sea-

Water rough today.

Ship still rolling. Going
very slow. Movie tonight

"Girl Crazy". Making 92
knots a day! Unbelievable!

Thurs. Jan 31, 1946 At Sea

Increased speed to
86 turns. If we keep up
this speed will hit
Pearl Harbor in 15 days
instead of 20. Movie

tonight "Scared Stiff" (J.H.)

Fri. Feb 1st 1946 At Sea

Still going 86 turns.

Sea calm now. No waves

Sat. Feb. 2 - At Sea -

Nothing new! Trip

31.

very boring. wish I
was home.

Sun. Feb 3 At Sea.

Cooked Turkey today
for crew. Same old news.
Date line passed Wed. this
week.

Mon. Feb. 4 At Sea.

Had target practice today
with .45 pistols. My ears
are still ringing. I also fired
the 30 rifle. Had a fire in
the Engine room today. No
damage - no one hurt.

Tue. Feb 5. - At Sea -

Sea very calm. Gaining
speed. Making 85 turns. The
Ship that's going back with
us ran out of food today.

so they pulled alongside us
 & we shot a line over &
 sent them food. It took
 us about 2 hours. were
 very short now on food
 also. Water rationing cut
 to 3 - 15 minute periods.
 It's only on for 45 minute
 a day. It sure is getting
 tough. So hang in.

Wed. Feb 6, At Sea.

Today we ~~skip~~ ^{go} a day go
 back a day. So tomorrow is
 Wed. again. 8 days in the water.

Wed. Feb 6. At Sea.

Today we got the oven
 fixed & tomorrow we have
 bread. I haven't eaten any
 bread in 8 days. Just crackers.

Sea very calm, just like glass. Today we seen 6 whales. Began they beg.

Thurs. Feb 7 At Sea.

Joe became the tailor man on here. Joe made 11.50 already sewing pants, rates & buttons. I can use the money cause I lost another 50.00 in crapes.

Fri. Feb 8 At Sea.

The ship going to the states with us broke down & we had to wait 6 hours for them. While we were waiting we caught 2 sharks. We seen more whales. Tomorrow personnel inspection. white uniforms & all. Today we failed inspection in the galley. We got 12 hours extra.

duty cause of that. And we
 spent 6 hours last night
 cleaning up too. They haven't
 any hearts. For the past 2
 days we've all been freezing.
 And guess what the tempera-
 ture was, only 79 degrees? Imagine
 freezing in that warm weather!
 But after spending 7 months
 in the Phil. with a tempera-
 ture of 100° to 120° anything lower
 than that & we freeze. The docs
 have been giving us some pills
 so we won't catch cold. I
 don't know how well it takes
 when we're in the states
 & it's about 40 degrees. I use
 a blanket now.

Sat Feb. 9 1946 "Sea"

Today personnel inspection was
 strictest I've ever attended.
 we were given extra duty for
 each thing as, no buttons, shoe
 lace untied, not evenly pressed clothes,
 and spots & etc. I was alright.
 I also took pictures of the crew
 dressed up. Expected to arrive in P.H.
 about Tues. Morning.

Sun. Feb 10 At Sea
 Weather getting cold again.
 Wish we had warm clothes.
 Getting my dress sent out for
 Liberty in P.H.

Mon. 11 Feb At Sea -
 Arrived at Pearl Harbor
 but couldn't go in yet.

Tue. 12 Feb - at Port Hawaii
 Anchored there.

Last anchor pool which was
 for \$250.00. Got liberty today
 & the place is swell. Just
 like Frisco. Bars, dancehalls,
 taxis, everything. I send a
 Radiogram home to mom. I
 went to the Waikiki Beach
 & Royal Palms Hotel & the Moana
 Hotel. All together I spent
 \$46.00. I have to borrow
 some more so I can go today.
 Wed. Feb. 13 At Port Hawaii

Went on liberty again
 today & had a swell time.
 We all got drunk. I think
 I'll get a taxi Saturday. I
 wish I had more money.
 Received 20 letters today.
 I'll write a few now.

Thurs, Feb. 14 At Port Haw.
 went on liberty again
 I can't get enough of
 liberty to suit me. Bay
 these Hawaiians are nice.
 what pretty girls! A
 lot of American are too.
 I'll take either one. I can't
 wait ^{but} the states now.

Fri. Feb 15 At Port

7:30 A.M. Hawaii

It's now Sat. morning. I
 couldn't write last night
 cause I was unexpectedly
 taken drunk. In sober now
 though & liberty starts at
 1:00 PM this morning & I'm
 ready to go. I'm getting a
 cattle today. I hope to ~~hook~~!

38,

Sat. Feb 16, 1946 - Hawaii

I got paid today & I drew \$110.00. I won't last long. I never spend so much money in my whole life so fast.

Sun. Feb 17 - Honolulu

Stayed aboard ship today & rest up a bit cause I'm going on liberty tomorrow. I borrowed \$50.00 from my buddies.

Mon Feb 18 Honolulu Hawaii

I had small liberty today. I bought some bell bottom dungarees, a lighter, belt, picture & drinks. I spent 30.00 & it was my last liberty cause we're leaving Wed for Tusco.

Tue. Feb 19 - Hawaii

back from

liberty. Tomorrow we head home. Expect to pull in on 5 March at 7:30 A.M.

Wed. Feb 20. Hawaii

Bad news the engine craped out & we can't leave yet for 2 or 3 days. More bad news is they sent a list of names ashore of the law patrol men. In one of them. It looks as if it might be left here. And after spending 6 months in the Philippines. Bay am I mad. Went on liberty.

Thurs. Feb 21 At Sea

Left Hawaii at 4 P.M.

This noon. They fixed the engine pretty fast. This morning we got a call from

the beach to leave 13 low
point men here. It sure was
a rotten trick to play on the
men. The captain said he
was glad to say we felt
like killing him. The rest!
I was lucky, I wasn't
called cause I've been on
here longer than most of
the S/C & I have 3 more
points than them.

Fri. Feb. 22 At Sea.

Since we left yesterday
at 4 till 12 noon today we
covered 165 miles. That's
good for us. Will make it
in 13 days now.

Sat Feb 23 At Sea.

Sea very rough today. The

ship is rolling pretty bad.
and even walk straight. It's
also very cold out. I wouldn't
be you and to us it is. The
lecture tonight was "Drifters
even". It was very good.

Sun. Feb 24 At Sea

The sea was pretty calm
today. We had a fire drill & a
harden ship drill. We were
told today that we'd hit
Guasco in 7 more days if we
keep this speed. I hope so.
I miss you all a lot. Inception
this Sat & Sun. I hope I pass.

Mon. Feb 25 At Sea

Sea very calm. Making
good progress now. Covered
213 miles today. OK!

42.

Tue. Feb 26 At Sea

Sea getting rough again.
Weather very bad. Rain & fog
for 2 days. This is Calif
weather now. Everyone is freezing
They finally issued jackets
Boy and I sold. Did some
more sewing. (5 more days.)

Wed. Feb 27 - At Sea -

Sea pretty calm now.
Rain still coming down. About
15 minutes ago the bridge
spotted a distress flare
& we're now on our way
in that direction. They
think its a downed plane
cause of the bad weather. I'll
let you know tomorrow -
will waste a lot of time now

Thurs. Feb. 28 At Sea

We didn't find the lost plane, but we tried. Nothing new.

March 1st

Fri. Feb 29 At Sea

Sea pretty calm. I got a carbine last nite. I hope I can get it off. Just 3 more days.

Sat. March 2 At Sea

Inspection went over very good. The galley got 4.0. Very cold out.

Sun. March 3 - At Sea

Today's personnel went O.H. We were in dress uniforms & held our undersides jumper on our arm. Very strict. Today

the sea was the roughest
 its ever been. Every time
 I go on deck I get a bath
 its coming over the bow
 & even the gunnells. The
 weather seems like its
 below zero. When it gets
 rough at sea it really
 stays rough. I hope it
 calms down. We were told
 to expect rough weather near
 Truco. We will pull in
 tomorrow morning. Today is
 our 58th day at sea from
 the Philippines & tomorrow
 our last. I'll call up
 as soon as I get ashore.
 I'll also send a wire. I'll
 be home for liberty

I hope I get my leave
 soon as his very anxious
 to get home. I was told
 I'd make 3rd class
 petty officer before I got
 off. Well tomorrow is
 my last day at sea on
 this ship. It's being
 decommissioned & I'll get
 a new ship now. I
 hope I get discharged.
 no more water rationing.
 We were told we can wear
 a star on our Philippine
 liberation for the work
 we did in near Luzon
 & for the air raids on
 our fleet. We're finally
 near the U. States.

46.

Mon. March 4 At Port
San Francisco, United States
After 59 days from
the Philippines we
arrived in Frisco at
0830 this morning. We
went under the Golden
Gate Bridge & it sure
looked good. I went on
liberty today & had a
swell time. I sent a
telegram to you. I spent \$20.00.
That's sure is little.
Altogether I spent \$37.00
on liberty. That's about
6 days combined. The
states sure look good.
But I still wish
I was home. Twenty

47.

five men got discharged today. The ship sure seems deserted.

Tue. March 5 U.S. State
we don't know when
we're going to be discharged
so I still don't know
when my leave is due.
I hope its soon.

Wed. March 6 U.S. State
went on liberty today
again. I hope I get my
money order soon. I
got a date for Sat.
dine with Dorlores.
my buddy who lives
here fixed it up for
me. I sure will feel
funny. We went dining

48.

today & I had to learn
all over. But I got used
to it again. I sure like
to dance.

Thurs, 7 March U.S.

I received an answer to
my telegram & I have to
pick the money up at
San Francisco. We
moved today to Oakland.
we left Buco cause
the piers were all taken.
No mail yet! Going
on liberty soon. I to
now 7 P.M.

Fri 8. March U.S.

I picked up my money
order for \$50.00. It came
in today. I had a date

49.

today & it was swell. My
ludde lives here & he
got an extra girl. That's
the first girl I kissed in
10 months.

Sat 9 March San Francisco
just wrote 4 letters home
& one to Marie. The weather
very cold. It's foggy all
the time. Rumor going around
that all leaves are cancelled.
I'll kill somebody if they
are.

Sun. 10 March Oakland
weather still foggy &
cold. ~~Nothing~~ to do. No liberty
today.

Mon 11 March Out in
Harbor

50,

Tue 12 March.

Wed 13 March.

Thur 14 March.

Fri 15 March

Sat 16 March

Sun 17 "

Mon 18 "

Tue 19 "

Wed 20 "

Thur 21 "

Fri 22 "

Sat 23 "

Sun 24 " Fr

~~Mon 25~~ receive

Had a small turn

Mon 25. War

Tues 26. Like

Wed 27. Sea

Thur 28. Li

Still waiting
Still waiting

- Same

- Pay day

- Nothing

Liberty & Olive

"

"

"

"

"

"

Liberty with Olive
& ring from her.

Liberty

Liberty with Olive
& Olive at Home
Liberty & Olive